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수능 영어 1등급 방어선 구축 · 최상위권 변별을 위한 고난도 빈칸 추론

[킬러] 1 다음 빈칸에 들어갈 말로 가장 적절한 것을 고르시오.

The standard view of scientific progress holds that empirical anomalies act as objective arbiters, systematically dismantling outdated theories. However, this narrative overlooks the degree to which our instruments are already theory-laden. When a scientist deploys a particle accelerator or a mass spectrometer, they are not using a neutral window onto nature; they are utilizing physical instantiations of the very physical laws they seek to test. The raw data produced are already structured by the assumptions built into the machine's design. Thus, when an anomaly is detected, it does not simply invalidate a hypothesis. Instead, it initiates a complex diagnostic dilemma: is the anomaly a signal of a new natural law, or a failure of the auxiliary assumptions embedded within the measurement apparatus? This epistemic circularity means that scientific inquiry often resembles an echo chamber where _____.

① we are forced to abandon empirical methods in favor of purely mathematical proofs

② the tools of observation pre-determine the ontological boundaries of what can be observed

③ technological advancement automatically resolves the theoretical disputes of the past

④ anomalous data are systematically discarded to maintain the illusion of paradigm stability

⑤ the subject under investigation is fundamentally altered by the consciousness of the researcher

[킬러] 2 다음 빈칸에 들어갈 말로 가장 적절한 것을 고르시오.

Algorithmic curation has moved beyond merely suggesting products to actively synthesizing our future preferences. By analyzing behavioral residue, machine learning models do not merely predict what we will desire; they preemptively structure the choices available, rendering our decision-making a reactive feedback loop. This predictive feedback loop creates a subtle tyranny of convenience. As the interval between desire and gratification shrinks to zero, the psychological space required for deliberation and self-reflection is obliterated. True agency is not merely the ability to select from a pre-determined menu, but the capacity to re-evaluate who we are and what we want in the face of friction, failure, or the unexpected. When algorithms flawlessly eliminate this friction, they do not liberate the self; rather, they freeze it. By feeding us a continuous stream of what we are calculated to want, they prevent us from experiencing the existential discomfort that is prerequisite to genuine transformation. In this sense, the ultimate consequence of perfect curation is _____.

① the democratic distribution of cultural capital across diverse social strata

② the absolute liberation of human desire from traditional social constraints

③ the arrest of personal growth through the systematic elimination of developmental friction

④ the emergence of a collective consciousness that transcends individual subjectivity

⑤ the heightening of consumer anxiety due to an overwhelming abundance of choices

[킬러] 3 다음 빈칸에 들어갈 말로 가장 적절한 것을 고르시오.

In an era dominated by the mandate of absolute communicative efficiency, literary difficulty is often dismissed as self-indulgent obscurantism. Yet, the deliberate cultivation of “unreadability” by avant-garde writers serves a vital political and aesthetic function. When a text resists immediate consumption, it disrupts the smooth, unreflective processing of information that characterizes digital capitalism. Modern media conditions us to treat language as a transparent, friction-free medium—a mere vehicle for rapid data retrieval. Difficult literature, by contrast, asserts the density and materiality of language. It forces the reader to confront words not as transparent windows to immediate meaning, but as opaque obstacles that demand active interpretation. This cognitive deceleration is liberating; it rescues the mind from the passive receptivity of automated consumption. By refusing to be easily digested, the difficult text acts as a sanctuary for _____.

① authors who seek to establish exclusive intellectual authority over their readers

② cognitive processes that are optimized for rapid decision-making in high-stress environments

③ thought that cannot be easily subsumed into the logic of efficient exchange

④ the preservation of archaic linguistic structures at the expense of contemporary relevance

⑤ an elite class of critics who control the distribution of cultural prestige

[킬러] 4 다음 빈칸에 들어갈 말로 가장 적절한 것을 고르시오.

The digital archive, with its promise of total preservation, was hailed as the ultimate antidote to historical amnesia. However, this infinite storage capacity has paradoxically destabilized our relationship with the past. In the era of physical records, the passage of time performed a necessary, organic triage. Materials decayed, documents were lost, and only certain artifacts were curated; this natural filtration created a hierarchy of historical significance and a palpable sense of temporal depth. In contrast, the flat, undifferentiated expanse of the digital archive preserves everything with equal fidelity. When the trivial and the monumental are co-present on the same screen, historical distance is flattened into a perpetual present. The past is no longer an exotic country from which we are separated by a vast chasm of time; instead, it is transformed into a database of style options, immediately accessible and infinitely manipulable. Consequently, the eradication of physical forgetting has not enriched our historical consciousness; rather, it has _____.

① accelerated the rate of scientific discoveries by democratizing access to raw data

② fostered a deep, empathetic connection to the struggles of past generations

③ robbed the past of its alterity and reduced history to a flat landscape of contemporary consumer choices

④ bridged the socio-economic gaps that previously restricted historical scholarship

⑤ forced modern societies to abandon outdated cultural traditions in favor of radical progressivism

[킬러] 5 다음 빈칸에 들어갈 말로 가장 적절한 것을 고르시오.

Evolutionary mismatch theory posits that traits adapted to ancestral environments can become maladaptive when the environment changes rapidly. A prime example is human cooperativeness in the digital age. For millennia, our ancestors lived in small, tightly-knit bands where interactions were face-to-face and repeated. In such a matrix, maintaining a cooperative reputation was vital for survival; defection meant ostracism, which was effectively a death sentence. Consequently, the human mind evolved highly sensitive psychological mechanisms to detect social cues, monitor reputations, and exhibit altruism, even when no immediate payoff was apparent. Today, however, we inhabit a hyper-complex, globalized world characterized by brief, anonymous interactions with millions of strangers. Yet, our evolutionary software remains unchanged. When we engage in virtue signaling on social media or donate anonymously online, we are often unconsciously satisfying ancestral algorithms that crave local social approval. This mismatch explains why much of modern prosocial behavior is _____.

① a highly logical and calculated strategy designed to maximize immediate economic gains

② a performative response to phantom cues of community monitoring that no longer exist in our actual physical reality

③ proof that human beings have successfully transcended their primitive, self-centered biological urges

④ a direct response to the physical presence of immediate kin who require urgent material support

⑤ an artificial construct manufactured by modern states to control unruly populations

[킬러] 6 다음 빈칸에 들어갈 말로 가장 적절한 것을 고르시오.

For centuries, Western art was dominated by the paradigm of representation, where the artwork functioned as a surrogate for something absent. A painting of a landscape or a sculpture of a hero pointed beyond itself to a transcendent referent, keeping the spectator at a safe, contemplative distance. Contemporary performance art, however, systematically dismantles this representational framework by prioritizing the aesthetics of "presence." In performance art, the event does not stand in for anything else; it is the event itself. When an artist performs an act of physical endurance or psychological vulnerability in the same physical space as the audience, the traditional boundary between art and life collapses. The spectator can no longer remain a detached interpreter of symbols, decoding the work from a position of intellectual safety. Instead, they are thrust into a shared, unmediated temporal reality where they are physically and ethically implicated in the outcome. By replacing semiotic decoding with raw, existential encounter, performance art shifts the focus of aesthetic experience from _____.

① the cultivation of elite taste to the democratic commercialization of art objects

② the emotional detachment of the artist to the subjective sentimentality of the viewer

③ the interpretation of meaning to the direct, visceral impact of co-presence

④ the preservation of historical techniques to the reckless pursuit of technological novelty

⑤ the passive admiration of natural beauty to the active exploitation of natural resources

[킬러] 7 다음 빈칸에 들어갈 말로 가장 적절한 것을 고르시오.

The conventional model of translation views it as a process of semantic transport, where the goal is to ferry a stable core of meaning from one linguistic container to another without spill or damage. This model, however, rests on a naive view of language as a neutral nomenclature. In reality, each language is a unique, historically contingent conceptual mapping of the world, complete with its own untranslatable nuances, cultural resonances, and syntactic limits. Therefore, translation is never a passive act of preservation; it is a productive betrayal. When a translator attempts to force a foreign text into a native tongue, they inevitably encounter resistance. The native language must be stretched, warped, and configured in novel ways to accommodate the alien modes of thought. Rather than a failure, this linguistic friction is precisely where the value of translation lies. It exposes the provincialism of our own language and forces us to recognize that our linguistic limits are not the limits of the world. Thus, the truest translation is not the one that reads most smoothly, but the one that _____.

① completely erases any trace of the source language to ensure absolute reader comfort

② demonstrates the inherent superiority of the host language over the source language

③ registers the foreignness of the original, thereby expanding the expressive boundaries of the host language

④ adheres strictly to the rigid grammatical rules established by traditional academic authorities

⑤ proves that all human cultures share an identical, universal cognitive foundation

[킬러] 8 다음 빈칸에 들어갈 말로 가장 적절한 것을 고르시오.

The concept of “hyperobjects”—objects so massively distributed in time and space as to transcend human spatiotemporal specificity—challenges the very foundations of traditional environmental ethics. Climate change, plutonium, and global plastic pollution are not localized phenomena that we can point to or experience directly; we only ever encounter their localized manifestations, such as a localized heatwave or a plastic bottle on a beach. Traditional human ethics are fundamentally localized and anthropocentric, designed for immediate cause-and-effect relationships within a visible community. We are cognitively wired to understand harm when we see a neighbor strike another, but we struggle to conceptualize the ethical weight of our individual, everyday carbon emissions. This cognitive and ethical scale-mismatch means that treating planetary crises as mere aggregations of individual local choices is deeply inadequate. Hyperobjects demand that we move beyond the immediate horizon of our senses. To truly address them, we must accept that _____.

① local environmental actions are entirely futile and should be abandoned in favor of pure technological optimism

② the natural world is a self-regulating organism that will inevitably correct human-induced imbalances

③ our traditional, localized frameworks of moral responsibility are structurally blind to the vast, non-linear systems we participate in

④ the global economy must be dismantled to restore the pristine, localized isolation of ancestral tribes

⑤ scientific models of climate change are too speculative to form the basis of concrete policy decisions

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